

ASTER

ASTER

Michaelmas daisy

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of annuals, biennials, perennials and subshrubs, grown for their daisylike flower heads. Prefers sun or partial shade and fertile, well-drained soil, with adequate moisture all summer. Tall asters require staking. Propagate by softwood cuttings in spring or by division in spring or fall.

- A. acris.** See *Galatella sedifolia*.
A. albescens. syn. *Microglossa albescens*. Deciduous, upright, slender-stemmed subshrub. H 4ft (1.2m), S 6ft (2m). Has narrowly lance-shaped, gray-green leaves and produces flattish sprays of lavender-blue flower heads, with yellow centers, in midsummer. Z7–10
A. alpinus illus. p.367. **‘Dark Beauty’** see A.a. ‘Dunkle Schöne’. **‘Dunkle Schöne’** (syn. A.a. ‘Dark Beauty’) is a clump-forming perennial. H 10in (25cm), S 18in (45cm). Leaves are lance-shaped and dark green. Deep purple flower heads are borne from mid- to late summer. Suitable for a rock garden. Z4–8
A. amelloides. See *Felicia amelloides*.
A. amellus ‘King George’ illus. p.250. **‘Mauve Beauty’** is a bushy perennial. H and S 20in (50cm). In fall, bears clusters of large, terminal, daisylike, violet flower heads with yellow centers. Leaves are lance-shaped, coarse and mid-green.
‘Nocturne’, H 30in (75cm), has deep lilac flower heads with yellow centers.
‘Rudolph Goethe’ has large, violet-blue flower heads. **‘Sonia’** has pink flower heads. **‘Veilchenkönigin’** (syn. A.a. ‘Violet Queen’; illus. p.249) has deep violet flower heads. **‘Violet Queen’** see A.a. ‘Veilchenkönigin’. Z5–8
A. capensis. See *Felicia amelloides*.
A. coelestis. See *Felicia amelloides*.
A. ‘Coombe Fishacre’. See *Symphyotrichum ‘Coombe Fishacre’*.
A. cordifolius ‘Silver Spray’. See *Symphyotrichum cordifolium ‘Silver Spray’*.
A. diffusus. See *Symphyotrichum lateriflorum*.
A. divaricatus. See *Eurybia divaricata*.
A. ericoides. See *Symphyotrichum ericoides*.
A. x frikartii ‘Mönch’. Bushy perennial. H 28in (70cm), S 18in (45cm). Daisylike, single, soft lavender-blue flower heads with yellowish-green centers are borne continuously from midsummer to late fall. Leaves are ovate and rough. May need staking. Z5–8. **‘Wunder von Stäfa’** (illus. p.249) is similar but has lavender flowers.
A. ‘Kylie’. See *Symphyotrichum ‘Kylie’*.
A. laevis. See *Symphyotrichum laeve*.
A. lateriflorus. See *Symphyotrichum lateriflorum*.
A. linosyris. See *Galatella linosyris*.
A. ‘Little Carlow’. See *Symphyotrichum ‘Little Carlow’*.
A. novae-angliae ‘Andenken an Alma Pötschke’. See *Symphyotrichum novae-angliae ‘Andenken an Alma Pötschke’*.
‘Autumn Snow’ see S.n.-a. ‘Herbstschnee’.
A. novi-belgii ‘Apple Blossom’. See *Symphyotrichum novi-belgii ‘Apple Blossom’*.

- A. ‘Photograph’.** See *Symphyotrichum ‘Photograph’*.
A. pilosus var. demotus. See *Symphyotrichum pilosum var. pringlei*.
A. sedifolius. See *Galatella sedifolia*.
A. ‘Sunhelene’. See *Symphyotrichum ‘Sunhelene’*.
A. thomsonii. Upright perennial. H 24–30in (60–70cm), S 20in (50cm). Produces long-petaled, pale lilac flower heads, freely in fall. Leaves are slightly heart-shaped. Z4–8. **‘Nanus’** is more compact, H 18in (45cm), S 10in (25cm).
A. tongolensis. Mat-forming perennial. H 18in (45cm), S 12in (30cm). Large, lavender-blue flower heads, with orange centers, are borne singly in early summer. Has lance-shaped, hairy, dark green leaves. Z4–8
A. tradescantii of gardens. See *Symphyotrichum pilosum var. pringlei*.
A. turbinellus. See *Symphyotrichum turbinellum*.

ASTERANTHERA

GESNERIACEAE

Genus of one species of evergreen, climbing or creeping shrub. May be grown up mossy tree trunks, trained against walls or used as groundcover. Needs a dampish, semishaded position and neutral to slightly acidic soil. Propagate by tip cuttings in summer or by stem cuttings in late summer or early fall.
A. ovata. Evergreen, root climber with stems covered in white hairs. H to 12ft (4m). Has small, oblong, toothed leaves. Tubular, reddish-pink flowers, 2–2½in (5–6cm) long, often with yellow-striped, lower lips, are borne singly or in pairs in leaf axils in summer. Z8–9

ASTILBE

SAXIFRAGACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering, rhizomatous perennials, grown for their panicles of flowers that remain handsome even when dried brown in winter. Suitable for borders and rock gardens. Most need partial shade, and a rich, moist soil. Leave undisturbed if possible, and give a spring mulch of well-rotted compost. Propagate species by seed sown in fall, others by division in spring or fall.
A. ‘Amethyst’ (x *arendsii* hybrid; illus. p.232). Clump-forming perennial. H and S to 3ft (1m). Tiny, star-shaped, vivid purple flowers are borne in long, rather open, slightly arching panicles in midsummer above sharply divided, matte, dark green leaves. Good at the back of a border. Z4–8
A. ‘Beauty of Ernst’ (x *arendsii* hybrid). Clump-forming perennial. H 10–12in (25–30cm), S 18in (45cm). Compact, ovate, sharply divided, vivid green leaves become increasingly tinted wine-red and purple, then develop fiery fall colors. Tiny, star-shaped, pale pink flowers, maturing to apricot, are borne in open sprays in early summer. Z4–8
A. ‘Brautschleier’, syn. A. BRIDAL VEIL (x *arendsii* hybrid). Clump-forming perennial. H and S 30in (75cm). Plumes of tiny, star-shaped, white flowers open in midsummer from bright green buds then

fade to cream. Leaves are ovate, sharply divided, glossy and bright green. Less vigorous than many taller cultivars. Z3–8
A. ‘Bressingham Beauty’. Leafy, clump-forming perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 2ft (60cm). In summer bears feathery, tapering panicles of small, star-shaped, rich pink flowers on strong stems. Broad leaves are divided into oblong to ovate, toothed leaflets. Z3–8
A. BRIDAL VEIL. See A. ‘Brautschleier’.
A. ‘Bronce Elegans’ (*simplicifolia* hybrid). Compact, clump-forming perennial. H 12in (30cm), S 10in (25cm). Pyramidal, slightly drooping panicles of tiny, star-shaped, purplish-pink flowers are borne in late summer on reddish stems. Ovate, sharply divided, dark green leaves slowly turn to reddish-purple. Z4–8
A. ‘Bumalda’ (x *arendsii* hybrid). Clump-forming perennial. H and S 30in (75cm). Tiny, star-shaped, bright white flowers are borne in open panicles in midsummer. Has more or less ovate, jaggedly toothed, red-tinted, bronze leaves. Z4–8
A. chinensis var. pumila. Clump-forming perennial. H to 10in (25cm), S to 8in (20cm). Lower two-thirds of flower stem bears deeply dissected, coarse, toothed, hairy, dark green leaves. Dense, fluffy spikes of tiny, star-shaped, deep raspberry-red flowers are produced in summer. Good for a shaded, moist rock garden. Z4–8. **var. taquetii ‘Purpurlanze’** (syn. A. ‘Purple Lance’, A. ‘Purpurlanze’) is tall and vigorous. H 4ft (1.2m), S 3ft (90cm). Has panicles of purple-red flowers over mid-green foliage in late summer and early fall. Tolerates drier conditions than most cultivars. **var. taquetii ‘Superba’**, H and S 4½ft (1.3m), is vigorous, with narrow, upright spikes of vivid magenta-purple flowers. **‘Vision in Red’**, H 28in (70cm), S 26in (65cm), is vigorous and upright. Has very dark, slightly metallic green leaves and strong, dark purple stems and leaf stalks bearing purple flowers.
A. x crispa ‘Perkeo’, syn. A. ‘Perkeo’, illus. p. 339.
A. ‘Deutschland’ (*japonica* hybrid; illus. p.232). Robust, slow-spreading, clump-forming, early flowering perennial. H 20in (50cm), S 12in (30cm). Has ovate, sharply divided, bright green leaves. Slightly arching panicles of tiny, star-shaped, white flowers are borne in late spring. Z4–9
A. ‘Düsseldorf’ (*japonica* hybrid). Tightly clump-forming perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 18in (45cm). Bears neat, regular panicles of tiny, star-shaped, salmon-pink flowers in midsummer above ovate, sharply divided, slightly bronze- or deep-red tinted, dark green leaves. Z4–8
A. ‘Eliblo’. See A. ELIZABETH BLOOM.
A. ELIZABETH BLOOM ‘Eliblo’ (x *arendsii* hybrid). Vigorous, clump-forming perennial. H 32in (80cm), S 2ft (60cm). Ovate, densely packed panicles of tiny, star-shaped, pale purplish-pink flowers are borne in midsummer. Has ovate, sharply divided, glossy, dark green leaves. Z4–8
A. ‘Europa’ (*japonica* hybrid; illus. p.232). Early-flowering, clump-forming perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 18in (45cm). In early summer bears tiny, star-shaped, unusually broad-petaled, pale purplish-pink flowers in dense panicles. Has ovate, sharply divided, glossy, mid-green leaves. Z3–8

A. ‘Fanal’ illus. p.439.
A. ‘Feuer’, syn. A. FIRE (x *arendsii* hybrid; illus. p.232). Clump-forming perennial. H and S 3ft (1m). Conical plumes of tiny, star-shaped, rich purplish-red flowers are borne in early summer above ovate, sharply divided, glossy, bright green leaves. Z3–8
A. FIRE. See A. ‘Feuer’.
A. glaberrima var. saxatilis. Mound-forming perennial. H to 3in (8cm), S 6in (15cm). In summer, produces tiny, star-shaped, white-tipped, mauve flowers in short spikes. Ovate, sharply divided, glossy, deeply toothed, dark green leaves are tinted red underneath. Thrives in consistently moist soil. Z3–8
A. ‘Granat’ (illus. p.232). Clump-forming, leafy perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 18in (45cm). Produces pyramidal trusses of tiny, star-shaped, deep red flowers in summer above broad, bronze-flushed, rich green leaves, which are divided into oblong to ovate, toothed leaflets. Z4–8
A. ‘Irrlicht’ (illus. p.232). Leafy perennial. H and S 20in (50cm). Bears tapering, feathery plumes of tiny, white flowers in summer. Foliage is dark green and flowers remain on the plant, dried and brown, well into winter. Z4–9
A. ‘Köln’ (*japonica* hybrid). Clump-forming perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 18in (45cm). Panicles of tiny, star-shaped, deep pink flowers are borne in midsummer. Ovate, sharply divided, dark green leaves are tinted bronze or deep red. Z4–8
A. ‘Montgomery’ (illus. p.232). Leafy perennial. H to 28in (70cm), S 18in (45cm). Bears tapering, feathery plumes of tiny, deep salmon-red flowers in summer. Foliage is broad and divided into leaflets; flowers, brown when dried, remain on the plant well into winter. Z3–8
A. ‘Ostrich Plume’. See A. ‘Straussenfeder’.
A. ‘Perkeo’. See A. x *crispa* ‘Perkeo’.
A. ‘Professor van der Wielen’ (*thunbergii* hybrid). Clump-forming perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), S to 3ft (1m). Arching sprays of tiny, star-shaped, pure white flowers are borne in early summer above ovate, sharply divided, fresh green leaves. Z4–8
A. ‘Purple Lance’. See A. *chinensis* var. *taquetii* ‘Purpurlanze’.
A. ‘Purpurlanze’. See A. *chinensis* var. *taquetii* ‘Purpurlanze’.
A. ‘Rheinland’ (*japonica* hybrid). Clump-forming perennial. H 20in (50cm), S 18in (45cm). Compact, conical, upright panicles of tiny, star-shaped, deep pink flowers are produced in early and midsummer above conspicuously divided, mid-green leaves. Z4–8
A. simplicifolia. Compact, dainty, mid-to late summer-flowering perennial. H 8–12in (20–30cm), S 8in (20cm). Has basal rosettes of ovate, mid-green leaves, which can be lobed or dissected, and arching sprays of tiny white flowers. Z4–8
A. ‘Sprite’ (illus. p.232). Clump-forming, dwarf, leafy perennial. H 20in (50cm), S to 3ft (1m). Has feathery, tapering panicles of tiny, star-shaped, shell-pink flowers in summer, borne above broad leaves divided into narrowly ovate, toothed leaflets. Z4–8
A. ‘Straussenfeder’, syn A. ‘Ostrich Plume’ (illus. p.232). Leafy perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 2ft (60cm). Arching, feathery,